



PROGRESS REPORT

Zambia: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 • 173 systems and instruments tracked

Of 173 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 58 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 31 did not, 31 carry no stated baseline, and 53 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD • GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • DIGITALISATION • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA • GEOPOLITICS • WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 145 sources for this place in the window — 21 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 124 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Zambia spent the twelve months to 6 August 2026 building collection systems and enforcement powers, and did not move the two measures that would show digital services reaching people. Government services onboarded rose from about 300 to over 400 ([Accountant General's office](#)), a government-owned private 4G network was launched, and enforcement of the Cyber Crimes Act was declared fully operational ([enforcement account](#)).

Over the same period internet use held at 33.0% of the population ([compiler analysis](#)), biometric enrolment on the national register did not clearly advance and its figures do not reconcile ([ministry account](#)), and biometric card issuance was deferred until after the August 2026 election. The data protection regulator, operational throughout, produced no enforcement action the base can record.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National AI Strategy	A parliamentary motion for an AI policy and legal framework was under public debate in July 2025; no strategy, draft or institutional home announced	A strategy text exists and is now held, which settles the question the three accounts of its stage left open: the technology ministry's statement of 2026-08-07 that the current strategy is nearing the end of its implementation cycle is consistent with the document, and the Presidential Delivery Unit's July 2026 description of one nearing completion is a reference to a successor rather than to this text. What the document cannot settle is which cycle is ending, its cover and its running headers giving horizons a year apart, and no successor draft is published	ADVANCED
Civil registration modernisation programme	The home affairs minister launched the 8th Africa civil registration day on three pillars - integration of civil registration with health, education, identity and social protection; modernisation; and decentralisation - directed at the 2030 legal identity goal	Unchanged; no further national measure, statutory instrument, coverage figure or target outturn appears in any held source, despite civil registration being described by the government as the bedrock of its digital transformation	NO CHANGE
COMESA Regional AI Strategy	Not established; the base carries no position on a regional AI instrument at 2025-08-01	Zambia's technology ministry, the regional secretariat and the World Bank launched the workshop in Lusaka, the first structured activity under the stakeholder engagement plan for the AI and emerging technologies consultancy; recommendations are to feed the regional AI strategy and regional digital inclusion strategy	BASELINE NOT HELD
National AI Strategy text	Baseline not held	The strategy text is held: a National AI Council with sector technical working groups, the Smart Zambia Institute coordinating implementation within government, the technology ministry leading adoption across the economy, and a National Emerging Technologies Centre of Excellence as the interface for international cooperation; priority sectors are agriculture, healthcare, mining, education, finance and public services, aligned to the 8th National Development Plan; data protection and ethics sit inside the governance framework rather than in a chapter of their own, with external alignment stated to the African Union's AI strategy and the UNESCO ethics recommendation and no bilateral partner named. Its implementation plan is organised by first 100 days, first year and second year rather than by calendar	BASELINE NOT HELD

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025, statutory text	The statutory text was not held, so the Act's provisions rested on secondary characterisation	Held in full. Assented 8 April 2025, published in the Supplement to the Government Gazette 15 April 2025, commenced 12 May 2025 by Statutory Instrument 22 of 2025; 66 sections in seven Parts, repealing and replacing the Cyber Security and Cyber Crimes Act 2021. Part V (sections 21 to 40) is the interception regime and is gated on a judge of the High Court	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Postal and Courier Services Bill 2026	Did not exist. Cabinet approved the review of the Postal Services Act No. 22 of 2009 in principle at its 17th meeting in September 2025, after the window opened	Ten-province stakeholder consultations concluded 2026-07-22 and a public call for written submissions closed 2026-07-27; the Bill would repeal and replace the 2009 Act, strengthen universal service obligations, modernise licensing, reinforce regulatory oversight and extend services to underserved areas through the universal access fund. No draft text, gazette notice or parliamentary date is on file	ADVANCED
Mobile money levy	In force under a 2023 levy act	In force, with the rate doubled at some point in 2025; the industry levy table is stated as current to Q3 2025. No Zambian rate, base, statutory instrument, effective date or revenue outturn is held	NO CHANGE
ICT (Universal Access) Regulations, 2012	No position held on the statutory basis of Zambia's universal-access levy	Statutory Instrument No. 38 of 2012 sets the licensee contribution to the Universal Access and Service Fund at not exceeding 1.5% of gross annual turnover, capped at 50% of total collectable annual operating fees payable to the regulator, payable annually in advance; the Fund may also receive parliamentary appropriations, grants and donations. No amendment, repeal or updated rate is on record.	BASELINE NOT HELD
Startup Bill	Baseline not held	Named once, alongside the National AI Strategy, as an instrument through which the government would advance artificial intelligence; no text, sponsor, drafting stage, timetable or budget is held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Act 2021	In force. Project documents describe safeguards as procedural alignment with the Act, and a 2024 account records staff in over 145 offices across ten provinces requiring training on it; civil-society monitoring current to late December 2025 records Cabinet planning to repeal it	Still in force and named by the information ministry on 2026-07-18 as one of three instruments regulating online communications, cybersecurity and personal data; no repeal bill, replacement text, statutory instrument, enforcement action or penalty under the Act is held	NO CHANGE
Office of the Data Protection Commissioner	Operational, with a controller registration deadline of 2025-04-30 recorded by civil-society monitoring; no enforcement action, registration count or annual report held	Unchanged in substance. The Office formed part of a multi-sectoral delegation to the continental identity conference alongside four other institutions, in sessions covering data-protection frameworks for digital identity; no registration count, enforcement decision, fine, breach notification, guidance note or annual report is held at any date. On 2026-07-31 nine civil society organisations asked the Office to examine the source of the contact list behind SMS messages sent to Social Cash Transfer beneficiaries before the 13 August 2026 election; no response from the Office is on the record	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Transfer of the refugee registration database to the home affairs ministry	Provided for in the refugee and host communities project, board-approved 2024-09-26 and effective 2024-12-23, closing 2028-10-31; the appraisal document records the transfer of the agency database to the ministry on separate servers, and a US\$6m identity limb enrolling refugees into the citizens' register across three districts. The only safeguard described is procedural alignment of departmental operating procedures with the Data Protection Act	Unchanged; no completion, transfer date, data-protection impact assessment, oversight arrangement or implementation status report is held	NO CHANGE
Data Protection Compliance Management System	Not held	Out to tender under the World Bank-financed acceleration project for a digital compliance management system to serve the Data Protection Commission, to integrate with the government service bus and payment gateway and to meet ISO/IEC 27001, ISO/IEC 27701 and WCAG 2.1 AA; a parallel tender under the same project covers a review of the national data-protection guidelines and compliance frameworks to strengthen implementation of the Data Protection Act No. 3 of 2021	BASELINE NOT HELD

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Zambian Secretary-General of the African Telecommunications Union	Baseline not held for the candidacy; the successful candidate had been the Union's Director for Radiocommunications since 2012, previously in spectrum engineering at the Zambian regulator	Elected Secretary-General at the Seventh Conference of Plenipotentiaries, taking office 2027-01-01 for a four-year term; Zambia was not elected to the 25-member Administrative Council for the coming cycle	ADVANCED
Kwacha onboarding to the regional real-time gross settlement system	Baseline not held	A regional central bank spokesperson said four states including Zambia are considering onboarding their currencies, potentially by the end of 2027; nothing in the base establishes that the Bank of Zambia has decided, and the electronic clearing house is separately reported as not yet live on the regional instant-payment scheme	BASELINE NOT HELD

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Ministry of Health ICT Standards and Guidelines	In force. The document states that the national electronic health record is the approved patient-level health care information system, in accordance with a circular of 5 April 2006 - the first held primary for that approval	Unchanged; no revision, replacement or superseding health-data standard is held twelve years after issue, and through the record's migration to fingerprint-based patient identity	NO CHANGE

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Public consultation on the Postal Services Act review	Baseline not held	The ministry invited any member of the public to submit proposals for amendment with justification, closing 2026-07-27, a window of three days from the call reported on 2026-07-24; no submission count, published responses or consultation report is held	CLOSED
Digital systems in the 2026 general election	Not held	Observer missions to the 13 August 2026 general election recorded a hybrid digital and manual voter-registration system with an online pre-registration portal, logging 8,786,300 registered voters, up 25% since 2021; a domestic coalition found election-day process largely transparent but flagged an online-only accreditation system that blocked 11 accredited monitors and the electoral commission's refusal to share the voters register; the European mission found online free expression unduly curtailed under the 2025 Cyber Security Act amid arrests for speech offences, and a regional media institute recorded a journalist detained for two weeks under the Cyber Crimes Act and judged the access-to-information law and decriminalised defamation paper victories undermined by the two 2025 statutes	BASELINE NOT HELD
Human Rights Commission election-period cases	Baseline not held	The Commission's chairperson said its case review meeting considered 105 alleged human rights violations and abuses linked to the election period, of which 62 were resolved through mediation, engagement with responsible institutions, referral for legal assistance, corrective measures and other redress; duty-bearers implicated included law enforcement agencies and justice-sector institutions	BASELINE NOT HELD
ZICTA consent judgment on internet access interruption	No position held on internet-shutdown constraints in Zambia at 2025-08-01	In force on the coalition's account: the regulator undertook not to act outside its authority to interrupt access and to state the reason for any future interruption within 36 hours, after civil society challenged the August 2021 blocking of four platforms; the technology ministry has committed not to shut down the internet at the 13 August 2026 election, and the government has said it could not establish the cause of the 2021 shutdown. No judgment date, cause number or enforcement instance is held	BASELINE NOT HELD

The cyber regime was already in force when the period opened and what changed was its activation. The Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025 commenced on 12 May 2025; on 18 July 2026 enforcement was declared fully operational, with compliance obligations extended across the financial, telecommunications, platform and e-commerce sectors ([enforcement account](#)). The cyber security agency moved from a statutory provision with no operating record to a body with a named director general running pre-election outreach and cited as the state's response to online scams and AI-enabled trafficking.

Nothing moved on the other side of the ledger. The Law Association's reported intention to challenge the cyber laws, dated April 2025, has produced no filing, hearing, ruling or withdrawal on the record. The Office of the Data Protection Commissioner, operational since early 2025, has produced no registration count, enforcement decision, fine, breach notification, guidance note or annual report at either end of the period. A Cabinet intention to repeal the 2021 Data Protection Act, recorded in monitoring current to late 2025, has produced nothing.

Two instruments did open. Cabinet approved a review of the Postal Services Act in September 2025, with public submissions on the replacement Bill closing on 27 July 2026, and directed ministries to adopt open-source technology in June 2026 alongside a national spatial data infrastructure policy and portal.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
K255 million digital infrastructure and quality-of-service allocation	No appropriation line found for any earlier year; this is the first domestic budget line the wiki holds for Zambia	ZMW 255,000,000 approved for upgrading digital infrastructure and quality of service, particularly rural, for fiscal year 2026	ADVANCED

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Government compact with the Payments Association of Zambia	Did not exist	Government and the association agreed to accelerate digital financial services and reduce cash dependency, with quarterly regulatory coordination between the technology ministry, the central bank and the regulator; a fourth mobile network operator was named and committed to the national financial inclusion strategy	ADVANCED
UNDP and Tony Blair Institute memorandum of understanding	Did not exist	Signed by the UNDP resident representative and the institute's country director, covering digital transformation and inclusion, public-sector capability, investment promotion, health systems including improved data systems, and climate-resilient agriculture. The Government of Zambia is not a party, though the areas were identified jointly with it	ADVANCED
Zoyk and Visa partnership	Did not exist	Launched to connect a Zambian fintech's local rails to a global card network for regional cross-border trade, with a keynote from the state ICT institute's national coordinator	ADVANCED
Digital identity memorandum with Ethiopia	The base fixes no date for the signing, and the related remarks were made in Addis Ababa in April 2025, so the memorandum may predate the window	Signed by the two national digital identity leads to collaborate on digital identity implementation; Zambia cites Ethiopia's domestically developed model as the reason for the choice	BASELINE NOT HELD

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital Zambia Acceleration Project	Appraisal-stage project information document dated 2025-01-20, status pipeline, expected approval 2025-03-27	Board-approved grant of SDR 73.9 million, about US\$100 million equivalent, in a US\$120 million total operation cost including US\$20 million commercial financing, implemented by the state ICT institute and closing 2030-10-31; components are broadband US\$50m, interoperable and secure platforms US\$38m, skills US\$5m and management US\$7m	ADVANCED
Improved Rural Connectivity Project	US\$200,000,000 committed in 2017, of which US\$141,100,654 disbursed, status active	Same amounts; the held record gives a closing date of 2025-12-31 while also carrying status active as enriched on 2026-07-21, and no source confirms closure or a final disbursement	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Zambia Refugee and Host Communities Project	A US\$30 million grant under the host communities and refugees window, board-approved 2024-09-26 and effective 2024-12-23, with agency technical support and the home affairs ministry as manager	Unchanged; a US\$6 million identity limb issues biometric registration cards to refugees and former refugees and enrolls them into the national register, with completion planned for end-October 2028	NO CHANGE
Lupiya digital lending	The base carries no earlier position on the lender	More than K500 million lent to over 120,000 customers since founding, operating in all ten provinces and two other African countries, with a further K500 million committed over the next decade targeting small businesses, farmers, traders and women entrepreneurs	BASELINE NOT HELD
Science and Technology Accelerator-Systems, Southern Africa	Baseline not held	Up to GBP2.5m over three years to March 2030 across Southern Africa, of which up to GBP400,000 for 2026/27; Zambia is named alongside Zimbabwe as the first year's focus, with South Africa the programme's primary one	BASELINE NOT HELD

The period produced Zambia's first domestic digital budget line the wiki holds: ZMW 255,000,000 for fiscal year 2026 for digital infrastructure and quality of service, against no appropriation line found for any earlier year ([approval account](#)). The record is built from press reporting rather than a budget document.

External financing was approved rather than disbursed: the acceleration project moved from appraisal stage to board approval on 11 September 2025, a US\$100 million grant within a US\$120 million operation closing October 2030, of which US\$5 million is for digital skills, with no training activity, target or delivery reported under it ([appraisal document](#)).

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Border-post connectivity upgrade across five trade corridors	No named border-connectivity programme is on the record; gaps at Nakonde, Victoria Falls, Kazungula and Chirundu	A single national standard announced through the government network - tiered 10 to 100 Mbps, dual links with automatic failover, enterprise-grade firewalls - and an independent network specialist firm commissioned to audit ICT infrastructure at five border posts; no budget, timetable or completion date published	ADVANCED
Chanida-Cassacatiza cross-border fibre interconnector	Did not exist; the base records cross-border infrastructure as missing at the January 2025 appraisal	The national backbone linked to Mozambique's submarine cable network under an operator partnership, with the minister stating Zambia is now fibre-linked to eight neighbours	ADVANCED
Government Wide Area Network	Site works complete at 12 Western Province sites, with last-mile connections by the state operator outstanding and the network not fully usable	All 116 councils reported connected and phase 1 completed, and North-Western Province local authorities and post offices connected over fibre; connectivity gaps persist at four named border posts	ADVANCED
GovLink Private 4G	Did not exist; no government-owned mobile network is on the record before July 2026	Government-owned shared 4G network for public institutions, live at Ndola Teaching Hospital, with the national electronic health record and its hospital tier migrating onto it; run by the state ICT institute with three named partners and the health ministry	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Mobile connections	19.9m connections, 92.1% of population (January 2025), down 1.1% year on year	23.5m connections, 106% of population (October 2025), up 1.3m year on year, of which 92.4% classed as broadband - a share the publisher states is not a proxy for mobile internet use	ADVANCED
National fibre network length	10,000 km of fibre optic cable in place, with the acceleration project aiming to add at least 2,000 km (World Bank appraisal, January 2025)	Expanded from 15,000 km in 2021 to more than 45,000 km, and national coverage 94% (minister, 2026-05-15) - government-reported and not reconcilable with the appraisal figure	ADVANCED, FIGURES IRRECONCILABLE
Quality-of-service enforcement regime	The regulator investigating internet service disruptions and requesting an operator report; no enforcement or reporting regime stated	The regulator states it will take visible action against mobile operators over poor quality of service and will publish quarterly public network-performance reports; no report, penalty or named operator action is on file	ADVANCED
Starlink service in Zambia	Live since October 2023, with state ICT institute kits in underserved public facilities since 2024 and installations at a rural clinic and two primary schools reported 2025-09-29	Kits reported at 23 youth resource centres nationwide during 2025, converting them into digital transformation centres; Zambia with Nigeria and Zimbabwe accounts for approximately 64% of an estimated 300,000 African subscribers (June 2026, vendor-market report estimate)	ADVANCED
Communication Towers Project Phase 2	US\$302,034,321.68 China Eximbank government concessional loan signed 2017-08-04 financing a vendor contract, 87.8% disbursed as of July 2022; scope 808 communication towers and 1,009 wireless stations, targeting 92% network coverage and data access for 40% of the country from a 5% baseline	Unchanged; no completion, handover or final tower count is held	NO CHANGE
Independent tower portfolio	Sole independent tower operator with over 1,700 towers serving all major mobile operators; US\$65,523,810 in development-finance equity committed in 2015 and 2017 and exited in March 2021, plus a US\$75,000,000 senior loan in 2021	Unchanged; no tower count, ownership change or investment after 2021 is held	NO CHANGE
Internet users as a share of population	7.13m users, 33.0% of population (January 2025), up 2.8% year on year with the rate unchanged; 14.5m offline	7.29m users, 33.0% of population (October 2025), up 199,000 year on year with the rate unchanged; 14.8m offline	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National ICT Development Project Phase II, backbone extension	US\$333,200,000 China Eximbank preferential buyer's credit signed 2017-12-28, to be on-lent to the electricity utility against a US\$392m vendor contract; scope 2,700 km of backbone across 64 sites, 3,600 km of metropolitan network in 17 districts and 2,750 km of access network; 0% disbursed	Unchanged; no drawdown, cancellation or construction record is held	NO CHANGE
Umoja cable terrestrial segment through Zambia	Announced May 2024 as a terrestrial route from Kenya through six countries to South Africa, built with a regional operator, with no service date held	Same route; ready for service stated as 2027. No Zambian landing point, capacity, counterparty or regulatory approval is held	NO CHANGE
Direct-to-cell satellite trials	No position held on satellite direct-to-cell in Zambia	Zambia named by an operator as a site of its direct-to-cell satellite trials, in an argument for regulatory parity between terrestrial operators and satellite entrants	BASELINE NOT HELD
Median fixed broadband download speed	16.50 Mbps, down 38.0% year on year (January 2025), corroborating the load-shedding constraint on digital services	No later reading is held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Memorandum of understanding on a national AI data centre	Did not exist	Memorandum for AI infrastructure, sovereign cloud hosting, digital public infrastructure for 25 ministries, a co-invested national data centre keeping critical data in-country, and about 5,000 young Zambians trained over three years; no value, site, capacity, timetable or co-investment split is disclosed	ADVANCED
Zambia National Data Centre and backup facilities	Main national data centre in Lusaka managed by the regulator, about 450 sq m with 72 server cabinets, a power room, monitoring room and two outdoor diesel generators, plus 400 sq m and 600 sq m backup facilities at the state operator's switch offices, built under a US\$65,468,016.48 China Eximbank loan signed March 2015	Unchanged; no capacity, utilisation, uptime, expansion or refresh figure has been published since	NO CHANGE

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Load-shedding as a constraint on digital services	Regular load-shedding of more than 20 hours daily following the drought that began in January 2024, stated to negatively affect digital services, with energy-access gaps named as a constraint that connectivity expansion must be aligned with	No later measurement of load-shedding hours or of its effect on networks is held	NO CHANGE
Solar power at local authority offices	No position held on power supply at council offices	The government chief technical officer states solar power has been provided to all 116 councils, enabling 24-hour service provision	BASELINE NOT HELD

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025	Assented 8 April 2025, gazetted 15 April 2025, commenced 12 May 2025; the Law Association had moved to mount a legal challenge and the United States embassy had warned its citizens that the regime requires interception of all electronic communications	Declared fully operational by the information ministry twenty-six days before the 13 August 2026 general election, with warnings that recording, publishing or distributing private communications without authorisation can bring prosecution and compliance obligations extended to financial institutions, telecommunications operators, digital platforms, mobile money providers and e-commerce businesses; no prosecution, charge or conviction count is published	ADVANCED
Zambia Cyber Security Agency	Provided for by the Cyber Security Act; no operating record, leadership, budget or activity held	Operating from its own premises from 2026-08-20, having previously shared space in government offices; running outreach around the general elections and, after them, publicly warning of an increase in hate speech, cyberbullying and insulting online content and reminding the public that creating, publishing, forwarding, reposting or deliberately amplifying unlawful and harmful content may constitute an offence; no budget, staffing, incident count or critical-infrastructure register is published	ADVANCED
Consumers targeted by digital fraud	81% of consumers targeted by at least one digital fraud attempt in the preceding three months (2025 wave, run in Q2)	81% targeted in the preceding three months, flat on 2025; 67% changed passwords and 42% added multifactor authentication in the prior 60 days, but 17% took no action, of whom 71% did not know what to do and 21% felt overwhelmed by the volume of security advice	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025	In force; establishes the cyber security agency and a critical-information-infrastructure regime, and per the embassy alert requires providers proactively to intercept all electronic communications via a central monitoring centre	The gazetted text is now held (assented 8 April 2025, gazetted 15 April 2025, commenced 12 May 2025 by Statutory Instrument 22 of 2025), and it does not read as the secondary characterisation did. Part V gates interception on a judge: section 29 requires a law enforcement officer to apply ex-parte to a judge of the High Court for an interception of communication order, valid three months and renewable once, and section 30 permits interception without a prior order only to prevent bodily harm, loss of life or damage to property, the officer having to put the written confirmation, an affidavit, the recording and a transcript before a judge within two days. Section 21 continues the Central Monitoring and Coordination Centre as the sole facility through which lawful interception is effected, managed by the division responsible for Government communications; section 39(1)(b) obliges providers to install interception facilities “when required by a law enforcement officer or under a court order” and section 40 empowers the President to make interception-capability regulations. Section 3(1) establishes the Zambia Cyber Security Agency in the Office of the President under his general direction; “law enforcement officer” extends to any person the President designates by statutory instrument	NO CHANGE
Law Association challenge to the 2025 cyber Acts	The Law Association was reported as set to mount a legal challenge against the cyber laws, framing them as a democratic backslide; no filing, cause number or hearing date on file	Unchanged at 2026-08-06. No filing, cause number, hearing, ruling or withdrawal is held in the sixteen months since	NO CHANGE
Lusaka safe-city surveillance system	Chinese-financed and Chinese-supplied safe-city surveillance in place; a development bank committed US\$210.8m to the government for the project, and 2023 research put Zambia among five African states each spending over US\$250m on such packages	Mapping across eleven countries finds Chinese companies supplied every country surveyed, records mass surveillance in Zambia despite no terrorism threat, and documents surveillance repurposed against political opposition; no Zambian authorising instrument, oversight body, procurement record, camera count or retention rule is held at any date	NO CHANGE
CCTV (Public Protection) Bill and National Public Security Command Centre	No position held	A Bill creating a National Public Security Command Centre is on the record as pending; no bill text, gazette date, parliamentary stage or budget is held	BASELINE NOT HELD
SIM cards deactivated for mobile-money fraud	No enforcement count held	43,500 SIM cards deactivated and K19.8 million secured between January and June 2026, attributed to consumer reports through a short code; no breakdown by operator, no recovery-to-victim figure and no prior-period comparison	BASELINE NOT HELD

The period's connectivity movement is a claim rather than a measurement. In January 2025 the World Bank appraisal recorded 10,000 km of fibre ([appraisal document](#)); in May 2026 the minister stated more than 45,000 km and 94% national coverage ([ministerial statement](#)). The two accounts do not reconcile and neither states its counting basis.

What did move is what the government owns. A government-owned private 4G network for public institutions did not exist a year ago and was launched at Ndola Teaching Hospital on 15 July 2026 ([launch account](#)). The government network went from twelve Western Province sites with last-mile connections outstanding to all 116 councils

reported connected with phase one complete — and then, on 5 August 2026, to a confirmed admission that four named border posts still lack connectivity, with a national bandwidth standard set and no budget or completion date attached ([status update](#)). Across the period, connected has meant completed site works at one end and live end-to-end service at the other.

A cross-border fibre interconnector to Mozambique was commissioned in February 2026 where none existed, and the regulator moved from investigating service disruptions to announcing quarterly public network-performance reporting, of which no report has yet appeared.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Government Service Bus	Central-government integration layer carrying sixty land e-services and identity and company-registry verification calls; no service or collection totals published	Over 400 government services onboarded across the service bus, payment gateway, national portal and payment platform, with over K8.8 billion collected cumulatively; extended to eight of 116 local authorities, returning about K21.7 million in the first month	ADVANCED
IDEA Programme regional coordination	Zambia the fifth operation of the multiphase approach approved 2024-06-27, with the regional economic community as coordinator; no forum or governance cadence on file	Inaugural annual digital forum held in Lusaka 27-29 July 2026 and the third steering committee convened 2026-07-30; Phase I stated as Zambia, the DRC, Malawi and Angola, with three further states preparing under Phase II	ADVANCED
ZamConnect data-exchange layer	Named alongside the payment and signature platforms as a critical enabler of the digital public infrastructure vision; no operational status, coverage or connected-agency count stated	Unchanged; no source on file reports it in operation or names an agency connected to it	NO CHANGE
National Carbon Registry	Not held	Launched as a fully digital registry embedded in the national measurement, reporting and verification system and interoperable with Article 6 of the Paris Agreement, developed under a donor programme with a UN climate centre, a consulting group and a green growth institute	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Biometric National Registration Card issuance	Credential option still being evaluated under identity-for-development technical assistance; no printer or card procurement stated	Smart-card printers and blank cards under procurement, cards to be interoperable within the national register, and issuance to begin only after the 2026-08-13 general election	ADVANCED, ISSUANCE DEFERRED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
MOSIP-based national digital ID system	Design stage; state ICT institute developers had completed platform training by 2025-01-17 with a view to integrating it with the national electronic health record, and the credential type was still under evaluation at appraisal	Implementation phase declared and an international system integrator being engaged for deployment, customisation and integration with civil registration, with the application layer to be built by Zambians on open standards; no integrator contract award is on file	ADVANCED
Biometric enrolment on the national register	1.5 million people enrolled with biometrics against 9 million adults (2024-09)	About 1.3 million enrolled (2025-12-28); about 1.5 million of about 20 million, roughly 7.5%, restated 2026-07-27	NO CHANGE
Integrated National Registration Information System	Operating; nearly 81% of legacy civil-registration records digitised and 1.5 million people biometrically enrolled (2024-09)	Operating; about 1.3 million enrolled and over 500,000 births and deaths registered (2025-12-28), with enrolment restated at about 1.5 million of about 20 million on 2026-07-27	NO CHANGE
National Registration Card, paper	Paper credential covering some 94% of the adult population (2021), the legacy system the digital ID is to replace	Unchanged; still the operative national identity credential, with biometric replacement not yet issuing	NO CHANGE
Nationwide mobile registration campaign for 3.5m ID documents	Running: a three-month campaign launched across all ten provinces targeting about 3.5 million citizens, free for first-time registrants aged 16 and over, with a K2 replacement fee	The scheduled three months ended in July 2025. No outturn - documents issued, provinces covered, extension or evaluation - is published in any held source	NO CHANGE

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cheque clearing	In use, with a June 2026 stop date reported 2026-01-13; no earlier dated position held	Being phased out, with the interbank settlement system carrying high-value settlement	ADVANCED
Government revenue collected digitally	K7 billion realised in digital transactions across the four years 2021 to 2025, stated 2026-03-25	Over K8.8 billion collected cumulatively through the service bus, payment gateway, portal and payment platform, of which about K21.7 million came from eight councils in the month to 2026-07-23	ADVANCED
Securities exchange mobile trading app users	49,611 registered users (June 2026)	51,791 registered users (July 2026)	ADVANCED
Social cash transfer disbursement	No disbursement figure held for the programme	More than K1.4 billion being disbursed to over 1.5 million beneficiary households in the July-August 2026 cycle, redeemable through beneficiaries own payment service providers over four weeks	ADVANCED
UnionPay e-commerce acceptance	A Standard Bank and UnionPay collaboration since 2024, with no online acceptance on record	Online acceptance open to participating merchants, settling in local currency, US dollars or both	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
ZamPay and the Government Electronic Payment Gateway	Named at appraisal as the platform for interoperable digital payments within the digital public infrastructure stack; no collection or channel figures stated	Collecting over K8.8 billion cumulatively across bank transfer, card, mobile money and cash deposit, extended to eight of 116 local authorities	ADVANCED
National Financial Switch	No dated position held at 2025-08-01; the base's only account of the switch is retrospective	In operation, connecting banks, non-bank financial institutions, payment service providers, fintechs and mobile money operators, carrying wallet-to-bank, bank-to-wallet and merchant payments with a QR industry project under way; the stated aim of lower transaction costs described by a vendor manager as not having happened yet	BASELINE NOT HELD
Regional digital retail payments platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	The regional clearing house published the scheme rulebook setting operational and governance rules for instant low-cost cross-border retail payments, and a gender audit and strategy to 2030 drawn from research along the corridor with Malawi	Baseline not held

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National Carbon Registry	Did not exist	Live in its first phase, covering Article 6-aligned projects, with all carbon-credit transactions in Zambia required to pass through it; administered by the Zambia Environmental Management Agency and linked to the National Integrated MRV System and to the UNFCCC Centralised Accounting and Reporting Platform, with a second phase to add voluntary-market registration and performance tracking; no address, operating rules, access terms or naming of the legal instrument is published (2026-08)	ADVANCED
National Spatial Data Infrastructure Policy and Portal	Did not exist; geospatial data described as fragmented, duplicated and inaccessible	Policy and portal launched, built on open-source software and aligned to the national development plan and the UN geospatial framework, and cited as underpinning land mapping and artisanal mining licensing; no dataset count, licence terms, access conditions or usage figure is held	ADVANCED
Birth registration rate	14% of births registered (2024); 6% of children hold a birth certificate	No later rate published by any held source; over 500,000 births and deaths registered on the national system cumulatively (2025-12-28)	NO CHANGE
Civil registration of births and deaths	14% of births registered (2024) and 6% of children holding a certificate, against a stated government target of 50% by end-2026; transition from limited to universal registration declared	Same target restated with integration, modernisation and decentralisation as the stated pillars toward the 2030 sustainable development goal; no updated registration rate published in the window	NO CHANGE
Zambia Integrated Land Administration System	Sixty land e-services on the government service bus, a national single-sign-on account required, payment platforms plugged in, identity and company-registry verification integrated, and a digital clearance mandatory before any land transaction and taking three to four weeks in practice	Unchanged; land administration cited as accessible online in North-Western Province (2026-07-08). No parcel or title count, cost, funder or evaluation is held	NO CHANGE

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Constituency Development Fund management information system	Did not exist in the base at 2025-08-01	In data entry across councils, intended to track fund transactions and payments individually; the June 2026 operationalisation date is not confirmed by any held source	ADVANCED
Emergency outbreak response platform	Did not exist	A platform built by the national public health institute with a research centre, holding outbreak information, response activities, teams and tasks in one place, in user-acceptance testing	ADVANCED
SmartCare 2.0 Hospital Edition	Did not exist	Piloting at Ndola Teaching Hospital, described as locally developed and owned, with full internet connectivity across Copperbelt health facilities targeted for July 2026	ADVANCED
SmartCare Pro national electronic health record	The SmartCare family collectively in use in approximately 1,800 health facilities across ten provinces (2025-03)	Deployed in approximately 80% of health facilities nationwide, with 2,000-plus facilities migrating onto the government private 4G network and patient identity established by fingerprint against the national digital ID service	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cabinet directive on open-source technology	Did not exist	Ministries directed to adopt open-source technology in line with digital transformation guidelines, on stated grounds of cost, security, reliability, customisation and avoidance of vendor lock-in; no directive text, circular reference, compliance deadline, exemption regime or monitoring arrangement is held	ADVANCED
Contract Tracking and Management Information System	Did not exist	In operation for digital submission of government contracts to the Attorney General's Chambers and real-time tracking of approval progress	ADVANCED
Digital loan system for civil servants	Did not exist	Under development by the state ICT institute, with the stated purpose of simplifying applications while strengthening verification to prevent loans being obtained in another person's name; nothing is published on the data the platform would expose to lenders, the legal basis for it, a timetable or a procurement route	ADVANCED
Electronic Government (Amendment) Bill	Did not exist; the Electronic Government Act No. 41 of 2021 in force unamended	Draft amendment presented, giving legal standing to electronic submissions and digital authentication through certified government channels and removing requirements for physical documents and handwritten signatures; not enacted on any held source	ADVANCED
Government services online	About 300 of an estimated 1,500 services (2025-01-20)	Over 400 services (2026-07-10)	ADVANCED
Online Passport Application and Payment System	Did not exist	In operation with application tracking and online payment, part of a paperless push projected to save over ZMW 400 million in stationery costs	ADVANCED
Property Management Information System	Did not exist	In operation and integrated with the national portal and payment platform for government property rentals, valuation consultancy, management department services and urban housing services, built by a local firm; no transaction, revenue or user figure published	ADVANCED
ZamPortal	About 300 of an estimated 1,500 government services online (2025-01-20)	Over 400 services onboarded, including passports, rent and road tax, payable by bank transfer, card, mobile money or cash deposit; Lusaka City Council the first of 116 local authorities live on the portal	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
SMART Office Management System	In demonstration at health ministry headquarters with Luapula as pilot site, chosen for existing government network coverage, and five further institutions named as next; estimated saving of up to ZMW 400 million in stationery and printing	Unchanged; no held source reports the system extending beyond the health ministry pilot	NO CHANGE

Collection advanced and identification did not. Services onboarded rose from about 300 of an estimated 1,500 at appraisal to over 400 ([Accountant General's office](#)), and the government service bus extended from central government to eight of 116 local authorities, returning about K21.7 million in the first month ([collection figures](#)). An online passport application system, a property management system and a contract tracking system all entered service where none existed.

Identity moved into an implementation phase without moving its numbers. Design-stage platform training gave way to a declared implementation phase and a system integrator procurement opened on 22 March 2026, with no contract award on file. Enrolment figures across the period run 1.5 million, then about 1.3 million, then about 1.5 million of about 20 million, with no revision reported ([ministry account](#)). Card issuance was deferred until after the August 2026 election.

One position did not move because it was never operationalised: the data-exchange component named at appraisal as a critical enabler still has no source reporting it in operation or naming an agency connected to it ([appraisal document](#)). The national electronic health record went the other way, from about 1,800 facilities across the SmartCare family to approximately 80% of health facilities ([institute account](#)).

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
e-Council platform	Did not exist at 2025-08-01; announced 2026-03-25 as a proof-of-concept phase one with eight councils, covering property taxes, business levy, market levy, health permits and fire certificates	Live at eight local authorities, collecting about K21.7 million in the first month for property rates, business levies and permits, with Lusaka City Council urging business and property owners to use it on stated grounds of minimising revenue leakages	ADVANCED
Local authorities on the national portal	Did not exist; no local authority on the portal	Lusaka City Council live, with seven further councils stated as due to follow by 2026-06-30 and no held source confirming they did	ADVANCED

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Satellite terminals in rural public facilities	Kits deployed in underserved public facilities since 2024, year only	A rural health clinic and two primary schools connected for access to government services through the national portal; no national count of connected facilities published	ADVANCED

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Cyber security agency artificial-intelligence remit	The Cyber Security Act was signed into law on 2025-04-08; no AI-related remit stated for the agency it created	The home affairs permanent secretary said the agency's establishment has strengthened the response to online scams and AI-enabled trafficking, alongside a review of the national trafficking policy and an amendment to the anti-trafficking Act	ADVANCED
ITU AI for Good Lab	Did not exist; the source describes the proposal as Zambia's first such lab	The technology ministry disclosed an opportunity to establish a lab with the International Telecommunication Union under the UN framework, expected to support AI policy development, innovation, skills and digital infrastructure; no signature, funding, siting or timetable reported	ADVANCED, OFFER ONLY
AI for Public Good Challenge	Did not exist	A three-month challenge under a development agency innovation initiative, run through university innovation pods at the University of Zambia and Copperbelt University, putting multidisciplinary student teams onto five operational problems submitted by government institutions - high-risk traffic factors for the road transport and safety agency, document verification for the revenue authority, passport guidance and national registration card indexing for home affairs, climate information access for the meteorological department, and a citizen service assistant for Lusaka City Council - with solutions built on sovereign computing infrastructure on campus and the strongest team from each pod advancing to a pan-African final	BASELINE NOT HELD
Feature-phone AI voice service	Not established; no dated position on the service is held at 2025-08-01	Users dial a number on any handset and receive AI-generated voice responses; early studies with an industry association record 59% of users as women and engagement higher than with traditional automated systems, particularly on health topics. No Zambian user count, launch date or operator arrangement is held	BASELINE NOT HELD
National Assembly artificial-intelligence automation	Not established; the base carries no position on parliamentary AI use in Zambia at 2025-08-01	The National Assembly is working with an implementing partner to automate routine public query handling, consolidate budget and administrative data and surface information to members during debates and committee hearings; the partner reports staff using public AI tools on personal judgment, limited monitoring of data flows into those platforms and no consistent approach to hallucinations	BASELINE NOT HELD

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Dot Com Zambia PLC	Not established; the base carries no position on the firm at 2025-08-01	A Zambian technology firm founded 2009 providing payment systems, revenue-collection platforms and digital business solutions including electronic tolling and levy collection, described by the technology minister as one of the first local technology firms to list on the securities exchange; no listing date, valuation or capital raised is held	BASELINE NOT HELD
Female co-founder and chief executive share of startups	Not established; no Zambia-specific prior-year value is given in the source	29% of Zambian startups sampled have at least one female co-founder, the highest of any country covered, and 22.6% have a female chief executive; continental context is 19.2% female co-founded against 17.3% in 2024, from a sample of more than 3,000 startups	BASELINE NOT HELD

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Mobile market subscriptions and turnover	Not established for 2025-08-01; the newest market-revenue figure the base holds predates the window by more than two years	Active mobile subscriptions 19.8 million at end-2022, down 2% from 20.2 million in 2021, with penetration falling to 101.2 per 100 from 110 after SIM-registration guidelines; mobile sector turnover ZMW 7.8bn in 2022, up 18% year on year	BASELINE NOT HELD

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Green Giraffe	Operating since 2022 on the founders' own account, though the base holds no dated position on the firm before 2026-07-31	A Zambian agritech pairing satellite imagery with artificial intelligence to route smallholders into premium markets, operating a virtual warehouse in which buyers specify variety, quality standards and compliance requirements before planting and contracts are signed pre-harvest	NO CHANGE
E-MARK Innovation Hub	Not established; the base carries no position on the hub at 2025-08-01, and the nine-month cycle it describes began around October 2025	A private Zambian innovation hub which identified and mentored the delegation that reached the global finals of the 2026 AI for Good summit and youth robotics challenge among nearly 50 participating countries, and co-organised the national recognition ceremony with the technology ministry and the Presidential Delivery Unit; no figures on size, funding, participant numbers or geographic reach are held	BASELINE NOT HELD
IGNITE digital economy incubator and accelerator	BASELINE NOT HELD	A twelve-month programme being staffed to run masterclasses, group coaching and access to funding for digital startups	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Padue	Not established; the source gives 2025 as the founding year without a month, so no position at 2025-08-01 can be stated	A mobile roadside-assistance marketplace connecting drivers to nearby providers for punctures, flat batteries and towing, with in-app messaging, notifications and real-time geolocation; no user numbers, revenue or funding held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Zambia's artificial intelligence position moved from a parliamentary motion to a strategy described as nearly complete, and no further. A motion urging the government to develop an AI policy and legal framework was under public debate in July 2025; by 17 July 2026 the Presidential Delivery Unit said the strategy was nearing completion ([statement](#)). No draft, publication date, budget or institutional architecture is held at either end, and a continental review of 1 July 2026 treats a Zambian strategy as an existing text — an unreconciled position the base cannot settle.

The one defined state AI mandate created in the period is defensive and sits with the cyber regulator, because no artificial intelligence institution exists.

The largest commitment of the period is a memorandum signed in June 2026 covering AI infrastructure, sovereign cloud hosting, digital public infrastructure for 25 ministries and a co-invested national data centre, with no value, site, capacity or timetable disclosed ([signing account](#)). It precedes the strategy that would govern it. A proposed United States health financing memorandum went the other way: a [five-year draft offering about US\\$1bn against ten years of health-data access and a 25-year pathogen-data pledge](#) stalled after Zambia requested revisions, and its own 1 April 2026 deadline passed with no signature on record.

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital Transformation Centres Initiative	The base holds no dated position at 2025-08-01; the same 2026 source states retrospectively, at year precision, that satellite kits were deployed to 23 youth resource centres during 2025	Run by the state ICT institute with the International Telecommunication Union and the youth ministry; computers, a projector and an industrial printer handed to the Mpika centre with two further handovers named	ADVANCED

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital skills and capabilities component	A US\$5 million component of an appraisal-stage project, expected approval 2025-03-27, status pipeline	A US\$5 million component of a board-approved US\$100 million grant closing 2030-10-31; no training activity, target or delivery under the component is reported	ADVANCED
Public officers trained in digital skills and data protection	A decentralised government digital-skills training programme was launched in December 2025; no headcount is recorded	146 public officers trained in Gwembe, Mazabuka and Siavonga in digital literacy, cybersecurity, data protection, e-government platform use and data management; no cumulative national total is published	ADVANCED
Vendor global academy training commitment	Did not exist	About 5,000 young Zambians are to be trained over three years through the vendor's global academy as part of a memorandum also covering AI infrastructure, sovereign cloud hosting and a co-invested national data centre	ADVANCED

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Revenue authority research memorandum	Did not exist	Signed by the Zambia Revenue Authority and an international tax and development research centre, covering research, capacity building and innovation for evidence-based tax administration	ADVANCED

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Financial inclusion, adult population	69.4% financially included (2020)	80.1% financially included (2025), with mobile money use at 76.2%	ADVANCED
Universal Access and Service Fund	Tower, last-mile fibre, learning-institution and inclusive-ICT programmes running; two named towers built in 2021 and 2025 were inspected in August 2025	Same programme structure; the 2026 assessment covers a special school serving 768 learners of whom 213 live with disabilities, and no new tower or coverage total is published	NO CHANGE

Financial inclusion rose from 69.4% of adults in 2020 to 80.1% in 2025, with mobile money use at 76.2% ([survey figures](#)). Internet use did not move at all: 33.0% of the population in January 2025 and 33.0% in October 2025, with user numbers growing only with the population, leaving 14.8 million people offline ([compiler analysis](#)). Mobile connections [rose 5.8% to 23.5 million](#) over the same period, which the publisher warns is not a count of people.

Data

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
2026 Abuja Declaration on Meaningful Connectivity	Did not exist	Adopted by African telecommunications ministers, defining meaningful connectivity as regular access plus a suitable device, sufficient data and a connection fast enough for video learning and commerce, and committing signatories to review sector-specific taxes and levies, lower taxes on entry-level devices, incentivise local assembly and reduce import tariffs on handsets priced below US\$50	ADVANCED

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Satellite and AI farm traceability platform	No position held at 2025-08-01	A Zambian platform pairing satellite imagery with artificial intelligence for smallholder traceability and market matching, built after commercial traceability software quotes ran to thousands of dollars a month, and stated to have changed how thousands of farmers interact with markets in under three years	BASELINE NOT HELD

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
United States health financing memorandum of understanding	Did not exist	A leaked five-year draft offering US\$1.012bn in health funding against commitments to hire 40,000 health workers and add US\$400m in health services, plus ten years of health-data access and a 25-year pathogen-data pledge. Zambia confirmed requesting revisions after the funding was linked to a copper and cobalt compact; the draft carried a clause terminating the process if no agreement was reached by 2026-04-01, and no signature is on file. Foreign Minister Mulambo Haimbe said in May 2026 that the proposed five-year agreement, which he put at up to US\$2bn, had stalled over data terms the government considers unacceptable, and the agreement was reported shelved in May after Washington sought signature alongside a critical-minerals pact	STALLED

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Zambia-China digital cooperation talks	Not established; the base carries no dated bilateral digital-cooperation position at 2025-08-01	A ministry director of digital communications and the Chinese ambassador discussed digital infrastructure, emerging technologies, digital skills, research and innovation, with the ambassador expressing willingness to explore initiatives; no agreement, value or timetable reported. At a Seminar on China-Zambia Artificial Intelligence Cooperation reported 2026-08-07 the ambassador restated support for Zambia's digital transformation, and the Chinese presentations covered localising artificial intelligence solutions to Zambia's context and partnering with universities to introduce AI curricula; no agreement, funding figure or institution is named At a further bilateral seminar reported 2026-08-17, senior officials attached explicit sovereignty conditions to deeper artificial-intelligence cooperation, the national coordinator of the government digital-transformation unit calling for safeguarded regulatory sovereignty and locally adapted governance standards, while China pledged 5,000 training places and the ambassador proposed cooperation on compute, 5G and data centres; no agreement, value or timetable is reported.	BASELINE NOT HELD

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Edge data centre plan	The operator's chief executive listed Zambia, alongside four other countries, as a high-potential country where it will create data centres, describing them as future edge locations	Unchanged; no site, investment figure, capacity or date has been reported since	NO CHANGE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Computer Incident Response Team	The full Project Appraisal Document's component text, which would state whether a national response team is funded, hosted or operating; the wiki holds only the datasheet and strategic context paragraphs	not yet probed
Central Monitoring Centre	The text of the Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025 and any commencement or establishment order; the base carries the Centre only as an embassy and civil-society characterisation, with no evidence it has been built, sited, staffed or funded	not yet probed
National cybersecurity policy or strategy	A published national cybersecurity strategy or the critical-information-infrastructure designation list required under the 2025 Act	not yet probed
Commercial and colocation data-centre capacity	A regulator or operator disclosure of installed and delivered IT load in MW, or rack count, by facility; the base holds no Zambian data-centre capacity figure of any kind after the 2015 build description	not yet probed
Government cloud and data-hosting arrangements	The state ICT institute's hosting policy or a government cloud contract stating where ministry data and the portal and service-bus workloads physically reside	not yet probed
National internet exchange point	A regulator or exchange-operator statement of peering members and traffic exchanged; the base holds no reference to a Zambian exchange point at all	not yet probed
International transit and wholesale bandwidth pricing	The regulator's annual market performance report for a year after 2022, or an operator's published wholesale tariff; the last market report the wiki holds is for 2022	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Power supply and backup at telecommunications sites	An operator or regulator statement of site electrification, generator and battery coverage, or reported outage hours attributable to grid failure	not yet probed
Electricity supply to data centres	A utility or facility-operator statement of contracted load and backup arrangements for the national data centre and any commercial facility	not yet probed
Satellite operator licence terms in Zambia	The regulator's licence award notice or fee schedule for satellite service providers; the held market report gives a continental fee range but no Zambian figure	not yet probed
4G and mobile broadband population coverage	A regulator coverage report by technology; the government's 92% and 94% coverage claims state no unit or measurement basis	not yet probed
Fixed and mobile broadband pricing	A price basket after the 2025 appraisal's statement that 5 GB of fixed broadband costs more than 12% of gross national income per head; no post-2025 Zambian tariff figure is held	not yet probed
System integrator contract award for the digital ID	The procurement award notice naming the integrator, contract value and delivery dates; the base holds the March 2026 procurement opening and nothing after it	not yet probed
Outcome of the April 2025 mobile campaign for 3.5 million ID documents	A registration department or home affairs ministry closing report for the three-month campaign, giving registration cards and birth certificates actually issued	not yet probed
Refugee biometric registration card issuance	The refugee and host communities project implementation status report, which would show disbursement and whether biometric registration under the identity subcomponent has begun	not yet probed
Land parcels or titles held in the land administration system	A lands ministry annual report or system statistics page giving titles issued, parcels registered or digital clearance turnaround times since 2023	not yet probed
Company and business register	A registration agency annual report or registry statistics release; the agency appears in the base only as a verification call from the land system in 2023	not yet probed
ZamConnect in operation	A service catalogue or project progress report naming agencies connected to it and the volume of exchanges it carries	not yet probed
Education management information system	A Ministry of Education statistical bulletin or system description; the base carries interactive boards and school connectivity but no named school information system	not yet probed
Central bank national payment system statistics	A national payment systems annual or quarterly report giving mobile money and switch transaction volumes and values; the base carries only inclusion rates quoted second-hand	not yet probed
Whether the seven pilot councils went live on the national portal by 2026-06-30	A local government ministry statement after 2026-06-30 listing councils live on the portal	not yet probed
Statistics agency release programme	Any statistics agency publication - census release, price index or national accounts bulletin, or its statistical release calendar; the wiki holds none, and every statistics figure comes from a compiler, the regulator, an agency or a survey vendor	not yet probed
Regulator annual or quarterly market performance report after 2022	A market performance report for 2023 or later; the only one held is the 2022 edition	not yet probed
A national earth-observation or satellite-data programme	A Zambian space or earth-observation policy, a national satellite data agreement, or the spatial data portal's dataset inventory naming its imagery sources	not yet probed
Data Protection Act statutory instruments and regulations	The Government Gazette carrying the Act's commencement order and any statutory instruments made under it on registration of controllers, transfer rules and breach notification	not yet probed
Data protection regulator enforcement record	The Office's annual report or a published register of controllers, complaints, breach notifications and enforcement decisions	not yet probed
Cabinet decision to repeal and replace the Data Protection Act 2021	The Cabinet decision or the gazetted amendment or repeal Bill; the base carries only a civil-society report's statement of intent, current to late 2025	not yet probed
Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025, statutory text	The gazetted text of the Act, which would establish whether the interception mandate and central monitoring centre attributed to it are provisions of the Act	not yet probed
Enforcement outturn under the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025	Charge, prosecution or conviction figures from the National Prosecution Authority or the Judiciary, or a ministerial statement to the National Assembly giving counts since 2026-07-18	not yet probed
Access to information law	A gazetted Access to Information Act or Bill; no held source states whether Zambia has one, and the base carries no position at any date	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National data-sharing, interoperability or data-classification standard	A state ICT institute published interoperability framework or government data standard; the base holds only a 2014 health-sector standard	not yet probed
Ratification of the AU Malabo Convention	The African Union list of signatures, ratifications and accessions, or a Zambian instrument of ratification	not yet probed
Parliamentary and public contestation of Zambia's data governance	Hansard for the sittings at which the cyber Acts and the data protection Act were debated; the base holds two sources on this subject and one is a paywalled lede	not yet probed
National open data portal and open data policy	A government open-data portal with a dataset inventory and licence terms, or a Cabinet-approved open data policy; the base holds only the geospatial portal	not yet probed
EU-Zambia digital cooperation	A European Commission or EU Delegation announcement, Global Gateway project fiche or financing agreement naming a Zambian digital investment; the base holds zero Zambia sources on this subject	not yet probed
Legal basis for personal-data transfers between Zambia and the EU	A European Commission adequacy decision, or a Zambian data protection determination or guidance on cross-border transfer mechanisms	not yet probed
Any Gulf-state technology engagement with Zambia	A bilateral agreement, investment record or ministerial visit involving the UAE, Saudi Arabia or Qatar; nothing on file, the base holding zero Zambia sources on this subject	not yet probed
Artificial intelligence budget line or implementation costing	The 2026 or 2027 national budget estimates showing an AI allocation, or a costed implementation plan annexed to the strategy	not yet probed
National artificial intelligence institution or agency	A statutory instrument or cabinet decision establishing a Zambian AI body; nothing names one, and the only institution on offer is the proposed international lab	not yet probed
National artificial intelligence compute inventory	A state ICT institute or ministry statement of installed government compute, or the technical annex to the vendor memorandum	not yet probed
Government innovation or venture fund	A budget line, fund charter or disbursement record; the base holds no Zambian public innovation fund of any kind	not yet probed
Technology hub inventory	A directory or count of Zambian innovation hubs; one hub is named anywhere in the base, and long-standing hubs appear nowhere in it	not yet probed
Zambian startup funding totals	The underlying diversity report, or an African startup funding report with a Zambia line; only continental aggregates are held	not yet probed
ICT sector contribution to GDP	A statistics agency national-accounts release with an ICT sector share; the Presidential Delivery Unit called ICT one of Zambia's fastest-growing sectors with no figure behind it	not yet probed
Ministry of Technology and Science annual appropriation	Zambia's Estimates of Revenue and Expenditure for FY2025 and FY2026, head-level lines for the technology ministry and the state ICT institute; there is no domestic budget archive for Zambia	not yet probed
Universal Access and Service Fund accounts	The regulator's annual report or the fund's own audited financial statements, giving the levy rate, fund balance and annual disbursement	not yet probed
State ICT institute appropriation and project counterpart funding	The acceleration project financing agreement or the estimates line showing the government's counterpart contribution against the US\$100 million grant	not yet probed
National digital literacy rate or programme	A regulator or statistics agency ICT household survey reporting digital skills prevalence, or a named national digital-literacy curriculum document	not yet probed
University or national ICT research institute	A named research centre's establishment instrument, funding line or publication record; no Zambian research institution appears in any held source	not yet probed
Digital skills targets under the e-Government Plan 2023-2026	The plan itself, which the hub names but no held source reproduces or quantifies	not yet probed
Gender gap in internet use or mobile ownership	An industry association gender-gap country figure or a regulator or statistics agency survey disaggregating internet use by sex	not yet probed
Rural-urban internet use split	A regulator market report or household survey disaggregating internet use by residence; the base gives only that 52.4% of the population is rural	not yet probed
Device affordability and data cost as a share of income	An affordability alliance or ITU affordability figure for Zambia; the base holds only the appraisal statement that fixed broadband exceeds 12% of gross national income per head	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Digital access for persons with disabilities	A national disability-inclusion policy or regulator programme document; the base holds only individual ICT donations to two special schools	not yet probed

The absences that shaped this period are the same ones that shaped the last. The regulator's most recent market performance report is for 2022, so no current subscriber, penetration, coverage or pricing figure exists against which any of the government's 80%, 92% or 94% coverage claims can be tested ([compiler analysis](#)).

Two outcomes from inside the period were never reported: the April 2025 campaign to issue 3.5 million identity documents produced no completion figure, and the regulator's announced quarterly network-performance reporting has produced no report.

Zambia also has no domestic budget archive and no statistics agency publication of any kind in the base, so neither the appropriations nor the statistics in this report rest on a primary state document.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-25
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ZMB/ZMB-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ZMB/ZMB-progress-2026-08-25.pdf
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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.